

Nicky Little

INTERESTING MAN

The skull under your face brought forward. Hollows and highlights only, no drawn lines. There is a second, deeper version for the Underworld.

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Costume Associate: Z Weschler
Costume Assistant: Ollie Reece

HEADSHOT

TIME
30 minutes, plus 8 for the Underworld

HELP NEEDED
None. You can do all of this yourself.

BEFORE YOU START
Your regular stage makeup should already be finished and powdered. This goes on top of it.

WHERE IT GOES

- The hollow under each cheekbone, running from your ear toward the corner of your mouth and stopping well short of it.
- The dip at each temple, beside the end of your eyebrow.
- Under your eyes and into the inner corners.
- Down the sides of your nose and under your jaw.
- Keep it off your eyelids. Nothing goes on the lid itself.

SUPPLIES

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| ☐ Grey brown water activated paint, one shade deeper than your skin | ☐ Two flat brushes, half inch and quarter inch |
| ☐ A second deeper grey brown for the Underworld pass | ☐ Red rubber stipple sponge |
| ☐ Pale cream or bone water activated paint for the highlights | ☐ A clean dry blending sponge |
| ☐ Light tan water activated paint for the mottling | ☐ Translucent powder and a puff |
| | ☐ Setting spray, hand mirror, water cup, paper towels |

STEPS

- 1 Powder your base and set up** 3 min
Dust translucent powder over your face and neck so the paint has something to grab. Sit where the light is in front of you, not above you. Overhead light makes its own shadows and you will end up chasing them.
- 2 Find the bone, then lay the hollows** 9 min
Suck your cheeks in once and feel where the bone ends and the hollow starts. That line is where the color goes, tight underneath the bone, never on top of it. Load the half inch brush with the first grey brown and lay it into the hollow from your ear toward the corner of your mouth. Stop two fingers short of the corner. Then the dip at each temple, then under your eyes and into the inner corners, then the sides of your nose and under your jaw. Keep it thin. You are going to build this up, not get it right first time.
- 3 Blend until there is no edge** 6 min
Take the clean dry sponge and work every edge until you cannot see where it starts. Blend upward into the cheekbone and downward into the jaw, never sideways across the hollow or you will flatten it. Stand back from the mirror twice while you do this. If you can see an edge from across the room it is a stripe, not a shadow.
- 4 Bring the highlights up** 5 min
Pale cream on the quarter inch brush, along the top of each cheekbone, on your brow bones, down the center of your nose and on your chin. Blend those edges too. This is the step that makes the hollow read. Shadow on its own just looks like dirt. The contrast is what turns it into bone.
- 5 Mottle the skin** 4 min
Light tan on the red sponge, blotted almost dry, pressed lightly over your cheekbones, your nose and your forehead. Broken and uneven. This takes the smoothness off and stops the contour looking painted on.
- 6 Seal it** 3 min
Powder everything, then spray with setting spray from arm's length with your eyes closed. Powder well under your eyes, that is where it will move first.

UNDERWORLD LOOK 8 minutes

Everything gets deeper. Nothing new goes on your face. Go back into the hollow under each cheekbone with the **second, deeper grey brown** and press it in hard against the underside of the bone. Carry it further toward the corner of your mouth than before, but still stop short of it. Do the same in your temples, under your eyes, down the sides of your nose and under your jaw. Then take the pale cream back over the top of your cheekbones and your brow bones so the contrast roughly doubles. Blend every edge again, the same way, upward and downward and never across. Powder and reseat. **If you find yourself drawing a new shape you have gone wrong.** It is the same skull, turned up.

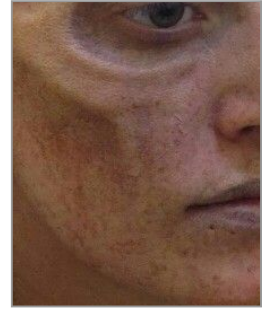
TIPS

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| <ul style="list-style-type: none">• Color goes tight under the bone, never on top of it. On top of the bone flattens your whole face.• Blend up and down, never across the hollow.• Stand back from the mirror as you blend. Contour that looks right at six inches looks like a stripe at six feet.• Stop two fingers short of the corner of your mouth. Taken further it reads as a jawl, not a skull.• The highlight is half the effect. Shadow on its own just looks like dirt. | <ul style="list-style-type: none">• Thin layers built up beat one heavy pass. You cannot take this off once it is on without starting again.• Light in front of you, not above you.• The Underworld pass is the same shape, stronger. New shadows will lose the skull.• Powder under your eyes properly. That is the first place it moves. |
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REFERENCE



The shape. Yours is more subtle than this.



The hollow sits under the bone and fades out with no edge.